



Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Founders Classical Academy: Lewisville
School Website: <https://www.founderslewisville.com/>

January 6, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Founders Classical Academy Lewisville, TX (75067) shows a robust classical orientation across most of the Six Elements rubric. Public materials on the school's site consistently foreground a knowledge-rich liberal-arts curriculum, explicit emphasis on Great Books and Western civilization, and a pedagogy that blends dialectic/rhetoric in the upper grades with knowledge-building foundations in the early years. There is clear alignment with formation of character, virtue, and wisdom, along with explicit attention to grammar, logic, and rhetoric as core tools of learning. Public materials also highlight a partnership model with families and a culture of parent involvement.

Two areas temper the overall classical alignment. First, while the school uses a classical framework and emphasizes virtue, truth, beauty, and moral formation, explicit references to liturgical practices or theology as grounding metaphysical foundations are not plainly evident in the public website content. Second, some elements of pedagogy (e.g., explicit singing/chanting in lower grades) are not described on public pages; the material emphasizes dialectic, rhetoric, and memory-based work in different stages rather than a blanket scholê/restful-learning language across all grades. Taken together, these factors place the school on a strong classical footing, with some room for deeper alignment in liturgical/theological framing and lower-grade contemplative practices.

Overall classification: CLASSICAL.

- Evidence of CLASSICAL alignment is strongest in Curriculum and Pedagogy, where Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, Latin/Greek roots, and Western civilization are foregrounded, along with a clearly formation-focused rationale for education. See curriculum/k-12 language and Great Books emphasis, including Latin/logic in the middle and high school, and the emphasis on original sources and Great Books.
- The school also explicitly describes formation through virtue and moral education, which aligns with the classical aim of formation rather than information.
- There is evidence of parental partnership and community involvement in the school's materials, consistent with the classical model's emphasis on parents as co-teachers and engaged communities.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school's public materials emphasize truth, goodness, and beauty as enduring ideals and stress virtue formation, aligning with transcendental realism and moral formation. They frame education as forming the heart and mind toward wisdom and moral character.

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- Direct theological or liturgical grounding is not prominently stated in the public site content; the materials focus more on formation, virtue, and classical canon rather than explicit liturgical practices or dogmatic theology.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: truth, beauty, virtue, formation, wisdom. The language emphasizes moral formation and transcendent aims. (Keywords drawn from the Six Elements lexicon's religious/meta-physical cues; see the taxonomy in the classical lexicon.)
 - Negative keywords present: liturgy, theology, doctrinal worship terms are not evident in the public site text. (From the positive/negative keyword framework, lack of liturgical/theological grounding is a negative signal for this category if taken as required.)
 - Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds formation and virtue as central aims and uses language around truth/beauty and moral imagination, which maps to Transcendental Moral Realism and formation, but it does not publicly foreground liturgical practices or theological grounding in the included public materials. This yields a BETWEEN classification: it clearly demonstrates classical aims in a moral/metaphysical sense (transcendental realism) but lacks explicit liturgical/theological articulation in the public-facing content. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school articulates formation of the human being, ennobling heart and mind, and promotion of wisdom, as the central goal of education, rather than mere information or job-readiness. It presents a paideia-like aim focused on virtue and human flourishing.
- The language explicitly contrasts formation with information and emphasizes a liberal-arts orientation and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty as real aims.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, paideia, great conversation (via emphasis on classic texts), true/good/beautiful, human flourishing. These map directly to the lexicon's School Purpose/Goal cues.
- Negative keywords present: none evident (the site does not foreground work-forcing career- or 21st-century-skills framing in its public materials). The absence of these is consistent with CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL signals.
- Why this rating
- The school's stated aim is to form virtuous, wise citizens through a liberal, classical education, not primarily to prepare for a job. This aligns closely with the classical school ideal described in the Six Elements lexicon, yielding CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The curriculum is anchored in liberal arts foundations (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and includes core knowledge, Latin/Greek roots, and logic training in the middle/high school; Great Books are explicitly part of the humanities emphasis; Western Civilization is explicitly foregrounded. The school explicitly identifies reading Great Books and engaging with primary sources, and a knowledge-rich Core Knowledge approach is used in K-8 with classical enhancements.

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- The curriculum highlights include: grammar/logic/rhetoric; Latin/Greek roots; Great Books; history/literature; emphasis on memory and close reading; and a high-school emphasis on a rigorous liberal-arts curriculum.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords present: Seven liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, Western Civilization, Latin/Greek, history, classical canon, poetry/language arts, close reading, memory/copywork. These appear in the school's curriculum-focused content.
 - Negative keywords present: The site does not emphasize social-studies-turned-history substitution, project-based learning dominance, or STEM-first framing; such signals are not present in the public text. This yields a strong CLASSICAL signal for Curriculum.
 - Why this rating
 - The explicit inclusion of grammar/logical/rhetoric, Great Books, Latin/Greek, and Western civilization, plus the commitment to a knowledge-rich Great Books-literature emphasis, places the Curriculum squarely in the CLASSICAL category per the rubric.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school describes dialectical learning in middle/high school and a rhetoric emphasis in high school, which aligns with classical pedagogy (Socratic discussion and rhetoric). There is explicit mention that upper grades engage in dialectical discourse and rhetoric, with a progression to advanced rhetoric and public speaking. This maps to the Pedagogy criterion.
- Lower grades emphasize a structure that includes grammar and memory of foundational material, and a knowledge-rich approach supports disciplined reading and close reading, but the explicit lower-grade singing/chanting or Scholé language is not described in the public pages. The presence of Socratic/dialectic in upper grades plus rhetoric training is a strong element, but not universal across all grade levels in publicly documented terms.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue, dialectic, seminars, rhetoric, speech, and memory work (as supported for classical pedagogy, even if not all forms are described publicly). The public text explicitly notes dialectical instruction and rhetoric development in higher grades.
- Negative keywords present: Lower-grade chanting/singing and Scholé-like contemplative/restful pedagogy are not publicly described; the public content emphasizes rigorous dialectical and rhetoric progression rather than a consistent catalog of restful or chant-based practices. This yields a partial fit to the “Restful Learning” and “Memorization/Recitation” subtypes in the lexicon as not clearly evidenced, pushing toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL on Pedagogy.
- Why this rating
- The presence of dialectic/Socratic-style discussion and rhetoric-focused instruction in upper grades supports a strong classical pedagogy signal, but the lack of explicit, consistent lower-grade restfulness, chanting/memorization, or chanting-based memory across documented materials reduces it from CLASSICAL to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

- Evidence

- The materials emphasize that teachers “inform, impart knowledge, and promote and model virtue,” indicating teachers as virtuous models and mentors and living curriculum. This aligns with the classical ideal of teachers as exemplars and the living curriculum.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: model virtue; mentor/teacher as exemplar; living curriculum; character formation; moral exemplars (as implied by virtue-molding language). The lexicon identifies “Teachers as Models of Virtue” and “Living Curriculum” as core signals of classical faculty.
- Why this rating
- The public materials clearly describe teachers as virtuous exemplars and central figures in forming character, which aligns with CLASSICAL in the Faculty category.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- The school emphasizes parent involvement and partnership with families, including parent formation and family engagement in classical education content, and openness to visits. The “Studying” page addresses parents directly and underscores parental investment in developing study habits, which supports a partnership model with families.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive keywords present: partnership with families, co-teachers, family involvement, parent formation, home-centered learning, parental leadership, school-parent synergy. The Six Elements lexicon lists similar signals for Parents & Community.
- Negative keywords present: none evident in public materials; the site appears to welcome parent involvement rather than position parents as mere customers. This aligns with CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- Public content demonstrates a strong partnership with parents and community around classical aims, consistent with CLASSICAL.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

- The strongest alignment appears in Curriculum, Faculty, and Parents & Community, with clear Great Books/Western Civilization emphasis, grammar/logical/rhetoric, and active parent partnership. The School Purpose/Goal also maps closely to formation and virtue, which matches the classical ideal. Pedagogy shows the essential classical elements (dialectic/rhetoric) but lacks explicit, universally documented lower-grade chant/memorization/restful elements; this yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signal for Pedagogy. The Religious & Metaphysical Foundations category is MIXED: foundational virtues and truth/beauty are evident, but explicit liturgical/theological grounding is not clearly present in public materials. This mix places Element 1 as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than fully Classical, contributing to an overall CLASSICAL classification.

What would move the needle

- If the school sought to move toward a stronger CLASSICAL standing in Pedagogy, it could explicitly document lower-grade contemplative practices (Scholé) and memorization/recitation routines (chanting, memory-work) in public materials to align with the liturgical, memory-rich pedagogy signals in the Six Elements lexicon.
- To deepen Religious & Metaphysical Foundations, the school could publicly articulate theological grounding or liturgical/community practices (e.g., morning prayer, chapel, liturgical calendar) if those are part of the program, or provide a clear, stated rationale for a non-liturgical but theologically informed framework consistent with classical Christian education.

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- Strengthen explicit articulation of a Great Conversation with direct references to the Great Books and primary texts as the core pathway for knowledge formation, ensuring a consistent public narrative that ties to the full lexicon of classical pedagogy.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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